

Lesson 14

1. ～にもかかわらず

Despite... / In spite of... / Although...

Used when something happens despite a fact or situation that would normally lead us to expect the opposite result. It often expresses surprise or a sense that the result is

The speaker expresses surprise that the previous fact or condition did not affect the outcome as expected. The following clause does not normally express the speaker's wish, intention, request, command, or invitation.

例：

1. 雨にもかかわらず、多くの人がイベントに参加した。
2. 彼はまだ若いにもかかわらず、豊富な経験を持っている。
3. 何度も注意されたにもかかわらず、彼は同じ間違いを繰り返した。

2. ～ものの・～とはいふものの

Although... / Even though... / While it is true that...

Used when the first statement is true, but the result or reality is different from what would normally be expected from that fact.

～とはいふものの gives a slightly stronger sense of “although it is true that...” and explicitly acknowledges the first fact before presenting the contrast.

The first part states a fact or something highly certain. What follows shows that things did not turn out as expected from that fact, or that some problem still remains. It is not normally followed by requests, commands, invitations, etc.

例：

1. 日本に長く住んでいるものの、漢字はまだ苦手だ。

2. 新しい仕事を始めたものの、まだ慣れていない。
3. 春とはいうものの、朝晩はまだ寒い。
4. 合格したとはいうものの、点数はぎりぎりだった。

Difference: ～ものの and ～にもかかわらず

～ものの → “Although X is true, however...” The speaker accepts X as a fact, but reality is not quite as expected or a problem remains.

資格を取ったものの、仕事が見つからない。

Although I got the qualification, I can't find a job.

～にもかかわらず → “Despite X...” Stronger emphasis on the fact that the result happened in spite of X, often with surprise.

悪天候にもかかわらず、試合は行われた。

Despite the bad weather, the match was held.

3. ～ながら（も）

Meaning & Nuance

Although... / Even though... / Despite being...

Used when the actual situation is different from what would normally be expected from the first condition. Similar to ～けれども, but more formal/written and often used with states, qualities, or characteristics.

It can also acknowledge a limitation or disadvantage first, before stating something positive or unexpected: “although X is limited/small...”

例：

1. 彼は若いながらも、会社の重要な仕事を^{まか}任されている。
2. 小さいながらも、この会社は世界中に製品を輸出している。

Difference: ～ながら（も） vs ～ものの

～ながら（も） → Although X, Y; often contrasts a quality/state with an unexpected quality or result.

若いながらも、経験が豊富だ。

Although young, he has plenty of experience.

～ものの → X is true, but...; acknowledges a fact, then says the actual result is not as expected or a problem remains.

資格を取ったものの、仕事が見つからない。

Although I got the qualification, I can't find a job.

Easy nuance:

～ながら（も） → Despite having this quality/state...

～ものの → It is true that X, but reality is...

4. ～つつ（も）

Although... / Even though... / Despite knowing/thinking...

Used when a person's action is different from what they know, think, or feel they should do. It often expresses an inner contradiction: "I know X, but I still do Y."

Often used with verbs related to thoughts, awareness, or speech, such as 思う, 知る, and 言う. The second clause states an actual action/situation, not a wish, intention, speculation, request, etc. The subject of both clauses is the same.

例：

1. 勉強しなければと思いつつ、テレビを見てしまった。
2. 悪いと知りつつも、彼にうそをついてしまった。
3. もう寝ようと思いつつ、スマホを見続けている。

Difference: ～つつ（も） vs ～ながら（も）

～つつ（も） → strong sense of “I know I shouldn't, but I still...”; often shows inner conflict.

体に悪いと知りつつ、たばこを吸っている。

Although he knows it's bad for him, he continues smoking.

～ながら（も） → broader contrast between two qualities, states, or facts.

若いながらも、経験が豊富だ。

Although young, he has plenty of experience.

5. ～といっても

Although I say... / Even though... / When I say X, it doesn't mean...

Used when the reality is different from the image or impression that the first statement might create. The speaker first says X, then corrects or limits the listener's possible assumption about X.

What follows shows that the reality is different from what one would normally imagine from X. The speaker is correcting, restricting, or qualifying the impression created by the first statement.

例：

1. 日本に住んでいるといっても、まだ半年だけです。
2. 英語が話せるといっても、簡単な会話だけです。
3. 旅行といっても、日帰りです。
4. 忙しいといっても、週末は休めます。

Difference : ～といっても vs ～ものの

～といっても → X is true, but don't imagine too much from X. It corrects the listener's impression.

料理ができるといっても、簡単なものだけだ。

I can cook, but only simple dishes.

～ものの → X is true, but the expected result does not follow / a problem remains.

料理を習ったものの、まだ上手に作れない。

Although I learned cooking, I still can't cook well.

